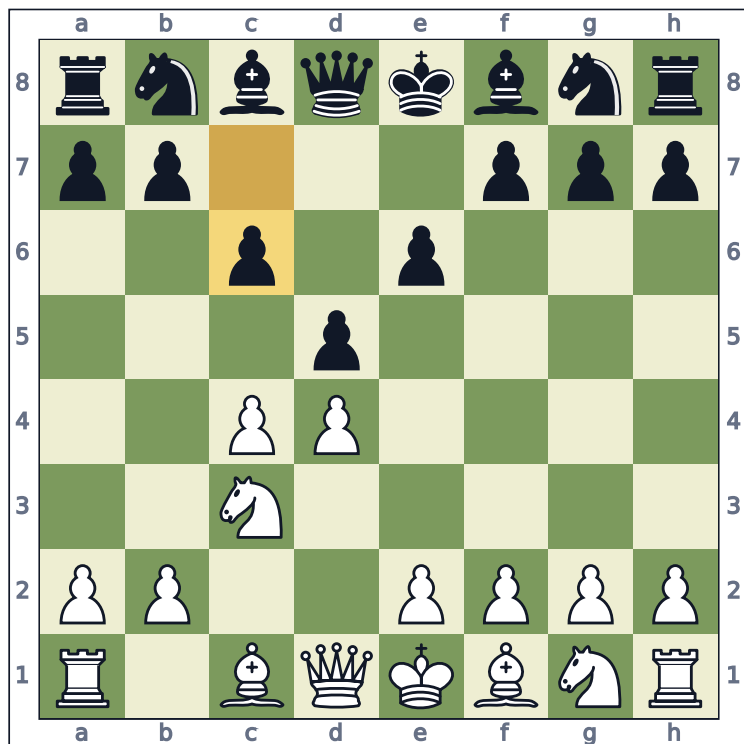


QUEEN'S GAMBIT STRUCTURES

Semi-Slav Defense

ECO D31 | 21 named lines in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Good and fully playable. The position remains within a normal opening balance for both sides.

ENGINE SNAPSHOT

+0.44 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

GAME CHARACTER

Principled and instructive: development and central breaks lead naturally into the middlegame.

WHAT THIS OPENING IS

D31 covers Semi-Slav Defense. White uses c4 to challenge Black's d5 pawn and seeks lasting central or queenside pressure. The diagram uses the featured line Semi-Slav Defense: Accelerated Move Order.

DEFINING ROUTE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 c6

UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

What both sides are trying to achieve

WHITE'S GOALS

Recover or transform the c-pawn investment, complete development, and choose between a central break and minority play.

BLACK'S GOALS

Maintain a sound d5 point, free the c8 bishop, and seek ...c5 or ...e5 before passivity sets in.

PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING

Black's ...c5 and ...e5 are freeing breaks; White commonly uses e4, cxd5, or b4-b5 in minority structures.

PIECE MAP

The c-file, d-file, and minority-attack squares matter. Bishops often improve after central exchanges. The central pawn placement should decide where each bishop and knight belongs.

WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG

Holding an extra c4 pawn can cost too much development; returning it at the right moment is often best. Recheck the center after every opponent deviation; opening names do not make moves automatic.

POSITION SNAPSHOT

White moves next. Material is level. Central markers: White pawn on c4, Black pawn on c6, White pawn on d4, Black pawn on d5, Black pawn on e6.

WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?

One of chess's most reliable and educational opening complexes, sound at every level.

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named D31 line

This section preserves all 21 names and defining routes assigned to D31 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

001 Queen's Gambit Declined: Alapin Variation

1. d4 e6 2. c4 b6 3. Nc3 d5

002 Queen's Gambit Declined: Charousek Variation

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Be7

003 Queen's Gambit Declined: Charousek Variation, Miladinovic Gambit

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Be7 4. e4 dxe4 5. f3

004 Queen's Gambit Declined: Janowski Variation

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 a6

005 Queen's Gambit Declined: Queen's Knight Variation

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3

006 Queen's Gambit Declined: Semi-Slav, Abrahams Variation

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 c6 4. Nf3 dxc4 5. a4 Bb4 6. e3 b5 7. Bd2 a5

007 Queen's Gambit Declined: Semi-Slav, Junge Variation

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 c6 4. Nc3 dxc4 5. a4 Bb4 6. e3 b5 7. Bd2 Qb6

008 Queen's Gambit Declined: Semi-Slav, Koomen Variation

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 c6 4. Nf3 dxc4 5. e3 b5 6. a4 Bb4 7. Bd2 Qe7

009 Semi-Slav Defense: Accelerated Move Order

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 c6

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named D31 line

This section preserves all 21 names and defining routes assigned to D31 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

010 Semi-Slav Defense: Anti-Noteboom, Stonewall Variation

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 c6 4. e3 f5

011 Semi-Slav Defense: Anti-Noteboom, Stonewall Variation, Portisch Gambit

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 c6 4. e3 f5 5. g4

012 Semi-Slav Defense: Gunderam Gambit

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 c6 4. e4 dxe4 5. f3

013 Semi-Slav Defense: Marshall Gambit

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 c6 4. e4

014 Semi-Slav Defense: Marshall Gambit, Forgotten Variation

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 c6 4. e4 dxe4 5. Nxe4 Bb4+ 6. Nc3

015 Semi-Slav Defense: Marshall Gambit, Main Line

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 c6 4. e4 dxe4 5. Nxe4 Bb4+ 6. Bd2

016 Semi-Slav Defense: Marshall Gambit, Tolush Variation

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 c6 4. e4 dxe4 5. Nxe4 Bb4+ 6. Bd2 Qxd4 7. Bxb4 Qxe4+ 8. Be2 c5 9. Bxc5 Qxg2

017 Semi-Slav Defense: Noteboom Variation

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 c6 4. Nf3 dxc4

018 Semi-Slav Defense: Noteboom Variation, Abrahams Variation

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 c6 4. Nf3 dxc4 5. a4 Bb4 6. e3 Bxc3+ 7. bxc3 b5 8. axb5 cxb5

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named D31 line

This section preserves all 21 names and defining routes assigned to D31 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

019 Semi-Slav Defense: Noteboom Variation, Anti-Noteboom Gambit

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 c6 4. Nf3 dxc4 5. g3

020 Semi-Slav Defense: Noteboom Variation, Anti-Noteboom Variation

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 c6 4. Nf3 dxc4 5. Bg5

021 Semi-Slav Defense: Noteboom Variation, Anti-Noteboom Variation, Belyavsky Line

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 c6 4. Nf3 dxc4 5. Bg5 f6